



Why is exercise important?

- When done correctly it gives us consistent energy and not so many slumps.
- It helps us live longer. This means we have more time with our loved ones and better-quality time.
- In a work context, it can give us valuable breaks from our desks. If incorporated in to your working day wisely then it can help you do more work and better-quality work. The work will also be completed in less time as you are energised and focused.

What no exercise can do to us?

- We will get sick and injured easier and more often.
- We will become stiff.
- It can lead to weight gain.
- It can contribute to low mood.

How to start getting better on exercise

1. **Start small** e.g. one push-up a day or get out of the bus a stop early and walk to work.
2. **Take ownership**, stop saying "I don't have time" for exercise and admit, "I'm choosing not to give it my time".
3. **Make it easy**. Leave your yoga mat out in view in the sitting room to remind you to do some stretching or push ups. You can even do this while watching your favourite programme.
4. **Use the 3 R's**. Set a **reminder** on your phone every 2 hours so that you get up and move away from your desk. Do a **routine** which you have learned like our stretches from the workshop. Note the **rewards** as you feel their benefit e.g. less stiffness and better energy & focus.

Mini habit recommendations

1. **Start by** getting up from your desk once a day and doing this stretch routine.
2. **Leave your yoga mat** in the sitting room so the next time you watch your favourite programme you are reminded to and then complete some stretches or push ups.

